MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準2級
リーディングトレーニング

第11回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全29問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜15	短文の語句空所補充
2	16〜20	会話文の空所補充
3	21〜22	長文の語句空所補充
4	23〜29	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検準2級形式のリーディング第11回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1 短文の語句空所補充

1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To save electricity, the escalator stays in standby mode until footsteps ( ) its sensor.

1 treasure **2** transfer **3** trigger **4** tremble

(2) After hiking through damp grass, my socks were soaked right ( ).

1 through **2** across **3** among **4** beside

(3) The town clinic gives priority ( ) patients with high fevers.

1 at **2** on **3** with **4** to

(4) You can borrow a folding umbrella at the hotel desk free of ( ).

1 price **2** charge **3** cost **4** fare

(5) Even experienced potters occasionally ( ) mistakes when firing a new glaze.

1 take **2** do **3** make **4** give

(6) So rapid ( ) the town's growth that two new elementary schools opened in five years.

1 were **2** did **3** had **4** was

(7) Please keep perishable dairy foods in the refrigerator so they do not ( ).

1 spoil **2** spill **3** split **4** spin

(8) The mountain hut has no running water, let ( ) hot showers.

1 only **2** alone **3** aside **4** along

(9) Volunteers cleared fallen branches to keep the drainage ditch from getting ( ).

1 clogged **2** clapped **3** carved **4** chased

(10) According to the ferry timetable, departures are subject ( ) weather conditions.

1 of **2** for **3** to **4** by

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(11) The tailor shortened my jacket sleeves by two centimeters at no extra (　　).

1 tax　**2** pay　**3** money　**4** cost

(12) Having (　　) all afternoon weeding the garden, Grandpa slept deeply that night.

1 spend　**2** spent　**3** spends　**4** to spend

(13) Local farmers set up a weekend market to sell vegetables (　　) to consumers.

1 director　**2** directness　**3** directly　**4** direction

(14) Could you keep an (　　) on my suitcase while I buy a bottle of water?

1 ear　**2** eye　**3** arm　**4** edge

(15) Hardly anyone expected the tiny island school to make it (　　) the national finals.

1 to　**2** on　**3** at　**4** with

2

会話文の空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(16) A: Excuse me. Why did the ticket machine spit my thousand-yen bill back out?
B: ( ) Try smoothing the corner or use this crisp bill instead.
A: Oh, it went right in! Thank you.

1 The machine is turned off.
2 Only coins from abroad work here.
3 Tickets are completely free today.
4 Folded corners jam the sensor.

(17) A: How was the stargazing camp on Mount Akagi last night?
B: ( ) Still, our guide gave an awesome constellation talk inside the lodge!
A: At least the trip wasn't wasted.

1 We didn't go to the mountain.
2 The sky was crystal clear all night.
3 Thick clouds rolled in right after dinner.
4 I forgot my swimsuit.

(18) A: Should we glue these poster photos down right now, Kenta?
B: ( ) Once glue dries, we can't move them.
A: True—let's arrange the layout first.

1 Hold on—let's place them loosely first.
2 Yes, pour all the glue on now.
3 Photos aren't allowed on posters.
4 We finished it last month.

(19) A: Did you find anything good at the secondhand book fair today?
B: ( ) It was out of print for ten years!
A: Lucky find! I know how long you've been hunting for it.

1 New books were twice as expensive.
2 Nothing at all—I stayed home.
3 Two loaves of rye bread.
4 An illustrated railway atlas from 1995!

(20) A: Would it bother you if I practiced my English speech aloud in the living room?
B: ( ) In fact, I can time you with my stopwatch!
A: Really? That would help me stay under three minutes.

1 Yes, please stop talking.
2 Not one bit—go ahead!
3 The speech contest was yesterday.
4 Living rooms have four walls.

3

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Wooden Cutting Boards Stay Popular in Professional Kitchens

When smooth plastic cutting boards entered home kitchens decades ago, many cooks assumed traditional wooden boards would soon disappear. Plastic boards were light, inexpensive, and easy to load into hot dishwashers. Yet walk into bakeries, sushi counters, and restaurant prep rooms today, and thick end-grain boards made of hinoki cypress, maple, or ginkgo wood remain a chef's favorite surface.

Knife care is the first reason cooks stay loyal to wood. Hard glass, stone, or stiff plastic dulls a finely sharpened steel edge quickly because the blade slams into an unyielding surface on every chop. Wood fibers, particularly when arranged vertically like bristles on a brush, part slightly under the knife edge and spring back afterward. This gentle cushion lets chefs (21).

Food-safety experiments also surprised early skeptics. Deep knife grooves in old plastic boards can trap moisture and bacteria even after a quick wash, whereas dry natural wood pulls liquid droplets inward via capillary action, leaving surface microbes without the water they need to multiply. Provided cooks wash a wooden board promptly and stand it upright to dry, traditional timber offers (22).

(21)

1 never sharpen a kitchen knife again in their lifetime

2 chop steel pipes and bricks in the kitchen

3 slice ingredients cleanly for hours without blunting their blades

4 melt butter without using a stove

(22)

1 lighter weight than a sheet of paper

2 a way to wash dishes without soap or water

3 automatic refrigeration for raw fish

4 both blade-friendly resilience and reliable everyday hygiene

4 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Notice About Locker Replacement in the Sports Center

From: Aoba Municipal Sports Center
To: Monthly Pass Holders
Subject: Empty rental lockers by May 28 for earthquake-latch upgrade

Dear pass holders,
To improve safety during earthquakes, the Sports Center will replace all 180 rental shoe and gear lockers on the first floor on Friday, May 29, and Saturday, May 30. The new steel lockers feature drop-proof latches that stay shut even during strong shaking.

If you currently rent a monthly locker, please take home all shoes, rackets, and toiletries before 9:00 p.m. on Thursday, May 28, and return your brass key to the front desk. Any items left inside on Friday morning will be packed in numbered bags and stored in the office for thirty days.

Your June rental fee will automatically be discounted by two days, and new wrist-band keys will be issued starting Sunday, May 31.

Sports Center Management

Notice About Locker Replacement in the Sports Center — Questions

(23) Why is the Sports Center replacing all 180 first-floor lockers?

1 To install new lockers with latches that stay closed during earthquakes.

2 Because termites ate the old steel doors.

3 To turn the locker room into a swimming pool.

4 Because nobody rented lockers this spring.

(24) What must current monthly locker renters do before 9:00 p.m. on May 28?

1 Paint their locker number on a bag.

2 Remove all belongings and return their brass key to the front desk.

3 Pay an extra fee for June.

4 Carry the heavy new lockers upstairs.

(25) What change will renters notice starting Sunday, May 31?

1 They will receive new wrist-band keys, and June's fee will be reduced by two days.

2 Locker rentals will end permanently.

3 The Sports Center will open only at night.

4 Brass keys will become twice as large.

How Sea Otters Help Underwater Kelp Forests Thrive

Along rocky Pacific coasts from northern Japan to Alaska and California, giant brown seaweeds called kelp grow upward from the seafloor like sunlit underwater forests. Towering strands of kelp shelter young rockfish, crabs, and sea snails while softening harsh winter waves before they strike coastal cliffs. Yet these lush underwater canopies depend surprisingly heavily on one furry marine mammal floating at the surface: the sea otter.

Unlike whales and seals, which rely on thick layers of blubber to stay warm in icy ocean water, sea otters have no blubber at all. Instead, they stay warm thanks to the densest fur in the animal kingdom AND a fast metabolism that requires eating roughly a quarter of their body weight in shellfish and sea urchins every single day.

That hearty appetite keeps the seafloor in balance. Spiny sea urchins graze on the root-like anchors that hold kelp stalks to rocks. When sea otters were hunted nearly to extinction for their pelts in the nineteenth century, sea urchin numbers exploded unchecked. Armies of urchins chewed through kelp anchors across miles of coast, turning rich underwater forests into bare rock "urchin barrens" where few fish could hide.

Where legal protection and conservation programs allowed sea otter populations to rebound in the late twentieth century, researchers watched a dramatic recovery unfold. By preying on exposed urchins, returning otters gave young kelp spores time to take hold and grow back into dense canopies—which in turn absorbed more dissolved carbon dioxide from coastal waters.

Studying otters, urchins, and kelp gave ecologists a classic example of a "keystone species": an animal whose everyday feeding habits quietly hold an entire ecosystem together.

How Sea Otters Help Underwater Kelp Forests Thrive — Questions

(26) Why do sea otters need to eat about a quarter of their body weight every day?

1 They swim across the Atlantic Ocean every week.

2 They store food in underwater caves for five winters.

3 Lacking blubber, they rely on dense fur and a high metabolism to stay warm in cold water.

4 Kelp leaves contain no water at all.

(27) What happened along many coasts in the nineteenth century when sea otters nearly disappeared?

1 Coastal cliffs grew twice as tall.

2 Kelp grew so thick that fishing boats could not move.

3 Whales began eating rockfish on dry land.

4 Sea urchins multiplied rapidly and chewed away kelp anchors, creating bare rock barrens.

(28) What positive change occurred where sea otter populations recovered in the late twentieth century?

1 Sea urchins went completely extinct worldwide.

2 Kelp forests regrew into dense habitats that also absorbed more carbon dioxide.

3 Ocean water turned warm like a tropical lagoon.

4 Crabs and rockfish left the kelp beds forever.

(29) What does the term "keystone species" mean as illustrated in the final paragraph?

1 The largest mammal by weight in every ocean.

2 An animal that builds stone arches on beaches.

3 A species whose feeding behavior plays a crucial role in maintaining a whole ecosystem.

4 A plant that grows only inside freshwater lakes.